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Technical Specification

**3rd Generation Partnership Project;
Technical Specification Group Services and System Aspects;
Security Assurance Specification (SCAS) for the next
generation
Node B (gNodeB) network product class
(Release 20)**



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Contents

Foreword.....	5
1 Scope.....	6
2 References.....	6
3 Definitions of terms and abbreviations.....	6
3.1 Terms.....	6
3.2 Abbreviations.....	7
4 gNodeB-specific security requirements and related test cases.....	7
4.1 Introduction.....	7
4.2 gNodeB-specific security functional adaptations of requirements and related test cases.....	7
4.2.1 Introduction.....	7
4.2.2 Security functional requirements on the gNodeB deriving from 3GPP specifications and related test cases.....	7
4.2.2.1 Security functional requirements on the gNodeB deriving from 3GPP specifications – TS 33.501 [2].....	7
4.2.2.1.1 Integrity protection of RRC-signalling.....	7
4.2.2.1.2 Integrity protection of user data between the UE and the gNB.....	8
4.2.2.1.3 VOID.....	9
4.2.2.1.4 RRC integrity check failure.....	9
4.2.2.1.5 UP integrity check failure.....	9
4.2.2.1.6 Ciphering of RRC-signalling.....	10
4.2.2.1.7 Ciphering of user data between the UE and the gNB.....	10
4.2.2.1.8 Replay protection of user data between the UE and the gNB.....	11
4.2.2.1.9 Replay protection of RRC-signalling.....	12
4.2.2.1.10 Ciphering of user data based on the security policy sent by the SMF.....	13
4.2.2.1.11 Integrity of user data based on the security policy sent by the SMF.....	14
4.2.2.1.12 AS algorithms selection.....	15
4.2.2.1.13 Key refresh at the gNB.....	15
4.2.2.1.14 Bidding down prevention in Xn-handovers.....	16
4.2.2.1.15 AS protection algorithm selection in gNB change.....	17
4.2.2.1.16 Control plane data confidentiality protection over N2/Xn interface.....	18
4.2.2.1.17 Control plane data integrity protection over N2/Xn interface.....	18
4.2.2.1.18 Key update at the gNB on dual connectivity.....	18
4.2.2.1.19 UP security activation in Inactive scenario.....	19
4.2.2.1.20 User plane data confidentiality protection over N3/Xn interface.....	20
4.2.2.1.21 User plane data integrity protection over N3/Xn interface.....	20
4.2.2.1.22 Checking expiry certificate.....	21
4.2.2.1.23 Peer certificate checking.....	21
4.2.3 Technical Baseline.....	22
4.2.3.1 Introduction.....	22
4.2.3.2 Protecting data and information.....	22
4.2.3.2.1 Protecting data and information – general.....	22

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4.2.3.2.2	Protecting data and information – unauthorized viewing.....	23
4.2.3.2.3	Protecting data and information in storage.....	23
4.2.3.2.4	Protecting data and information in transfer.....	23
4.2.3.2.5	Logging access to personal data.....	23
4.2.3.3	Protecting availability and integrity.....	23
4.2.3.4	Authentication and authorization.....	23
4.2.3.4.1	Authentication attributes.....	23
4.2.3.5	Protecting sessions.....	23
4.2.3.6	Logging.....	23
4.2.4	Operating systems.....	23
4.2.5	Web servers.....	23
4.2.6	Network devices.....	23
4.2.6.1	Protection of data and information.....	23
4.2.6.2	Protecting availability and integrity.....	24
4.2.6.2.1	Packet filtering.....	24
4.2.6.2.2	Interface robustness requirements.....	24
4.2.6.2.3	GTP-C Filtering.....	24
4.2.6.2.4	GTP-U Filtering.....	24
4.2.7	Void.....	24
4.3	gNodeB-specific adaptations of hardening requirements and related test cases.....	24
4.3.1	Introduction.....	24
4.3.2	Technical Baseline.....	24
4.3.3	Operating Systems.....	24
4.3.4	Web Servers.....	24
4.3.5	Network Devices.....	24
4.3.6	Network Functions in service-based architecture.....	24
4.4	gNodeB-specific adaptations of basic vulnerability testing requirements and related test cases.....	24
4.4.1	Introduction.....	24
4.4.2	Port Scanning.....	25
4.4.3	Vulnerability scanning.....	25
4.4.4	Robustness and fuzz testing.....	25
Annex A (informative):	Change history.....	26

Foreword

This Technical Specification has been produced by the 3rd Generation Partnership Project (3GPP).

The contents of the present document are subject to continuing work within the TSG and may change following formal TSG approval. Should the TSG modify the contents of the present document, it will be re-released by the TSG with an identifying change of release date and an increase in version number as follows:

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- x the first digit:
 - 1 presented to TSG for information;
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- y the second digit is incremented for all changes of substance, i.e. technical enhancements, corrections, updates, etc.
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1 Scope

The present document contains objectives, requirements and test cases that are specific to the gNB network product class. It refers to the Catalogue of General Security Assurance Requirements and formulates specific adaptations of the requirements and test cases given there, as well as specifying requirements and test cases unique to the gNB network product class.

NOTE: Test cases for the split gNB product classes are specified in TS 33.523 [9].

2 References

The following documents contain provisions which, through reference in this text, constitute provisions of the present document.

- References are either specific (identified by date of publication, edition number, version number, etc.) or non-specific.
- For a specific reference, subsequent revisions do not apply.
- For a non-specific reference, the latest version applies. In the case of a reference to a 3GPP document (including a GSM document), a non-specific reference implicitly refers to the latest version of that document *in the same Release as the present document*.

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|------|--|
| [1] | 3GPP TR 21.905: "Vocabulary for 3GPP Specifications". |
| [2] | 3GPP TS 33.501: "Security architecture and procedures for 5G system". |
| [3] | 3GPP TS 33.117: "Catalogue of general security assurance requirements". |
| [4] | Void |
| [5] | 3GPP TR 33.926: "Security Assurance Specification (SCAS) threats and critical assets in 3GPP network product classes". |
| [6] | 3GPP TS 38.331: "NR; Radio Resource Control (RRC) protocol specification". |
| [7] | 3GPP TS 23.501: "System Architecture for 5G System (5GS)". |
| [8] | 3GPP TS 38.300: "NR and NG-RAN Overall Description". |
| [9] | 3GPP TS 33.523: "5G Security Assurance Specification (SCAS); split gNB product classes". |
| [10] | 3GPP TS 33.310: "Network Domain Security (NDS); Authentication Framework (AF)". |
| [11] | IETF RFC 4210: "Internet X.509 Public Key Infrastructure Certificate Management Protocol". |

3 Definitions of terms and abbreviations

3.1 Terms

For the purposes of the present document, the terms given in 3GPP TR 21.905 [1] and the following apply. A term defined in the present document takes precedence over the definition of the same term, if any, in 3GPP TR 21.905 [1].

3.2 Abbreviations

For the purposes of the present document, the abbreviations given in 3GPP TR 21.905 [1] and the following apply. An abbreviation defined in the present document takes precedence over the definition of the same abbreviation, if any, in 3GPP TR 21.905 [1].

5GC	5G Core Network
AMF	Access and Mobility Management Function
gNB	NR Node B
NG	Next Generation
NG-RAN	5G Radio Access Network
SMF	Session Management Function

4 gNodeB-specific security requirements and related test cases

4.1 Introduction

gNB specific security requirements include both requirements derived from gNB-specific security functional requirements as well as security requirements derived from threats specific to gNB as described in TR 33.926 [5]. Generic security requirements and test cases common to other network product classes have been captured in TS 33.117 [3] and are not repeated in the present document.

4.2 gNodeB-specific security functional adaptations of requirements and related test cases

4.2.1 Introduction

Present clause contains gNB-specific security functional adaptations of requirements and related test cases.

4.2.2 Security functional requirements on the gNodeB deriving from 3GPP specifications and related test cases

4.2.2.1 Security functional requirements on the gNodeB deriving from 3GPP specifications – TS 33.501 [2]

4.2.2.1.1 Integrity protection of RRC-signalling

Requirement Name: Integrity protection of RRC-signalling

Requirement Reference: TS 33.501 [2], clause 5.3.3

Requirement Description: The gNB supports integrity protection and replay protection of RRC-signalling as specified in TS 33.501 [2], clause 5.3.3.

Threat References: TR 33.926 [5], clause D.2.2.2 – Control plane data integrity protection.

Test Case:

Test Name: TC_CP_DATA_INT_RRC-SIGN_gNB

Purpose:

To verify that the RRC-signalling data sent between UE and gNB over the air interface are integrity protected.

Pre-Condition:

- The gNB network product shall be connected in emulated/real network environments. UE may be simulated.
- Tester shall have access to the integrity algorithm and the integrity protection keys.
- The tester can capture the message via the NG RAN air interface, or can capture the message at the UE.
- The NIA0 is disabled at UE and gNB.

Execution Steps:

1. The tester triggers the gNB to send AS security mode command message to the UE, and UE responses AS security mode complete message.
2. The tester checks any RRC message sent by gNB after sending AS security mode command message and before UE enters CM-IDLE state is integrity protected.

Expected Results:

Any RRC-signalling over the NG RAN air interface is integrity protected after gNB sending AS security mode command message.

Expected format of evidence:

Evidence suitable for the interface, e.g. Screenshot containing the operational results.

4.2.2.1.2 Integrity protection of user data between the UE and the gNB

Requirement Name: Integrity protection of user data between the UE and the gNB.

Requirement Reference: TS 33.501 [2], clause 5.3.3

Requirement Description: The gNB supports integrity protection and replay protection of user data between the UE and the gNB as specified in TS 33.501 [2], clause 5.3.3.

NOTE: This requirement does not apply to the gNB that is used as a secondary node connecting to the EPC.

Threat References: TR 33.926 [5], clause D.2.2.4 – User plane data integrity protection.

Test Case:

Test Name: TC-UP-DATA-INT_gNB

Purpose:

To verify that the user data packets are integrity protected over the NG RAN air interface.

Pre-Condition:

- The gNB network product shall be connected in emulated/real network environments. UE may be simulated.
- Tester shall enable the user plane integrity protection and ensure NIA0 is not used.
- Tester shall have knowledge of integrity algorithm and integrity protection keys.
- The tester can capture the message via the air interface, or can capture the message at the UE.
- The NIA0 is disabled at the UE and gNB.

Execution Steps:

1. The tester triggers the gNB to send RRCConnectionReconfiguration with integrity protection indication "on".
2. The tester checks any user data sent by gNB after sending RRCConnectionReconfiguration and before UE enters CM-IDLE state is integrity protected.

Expected Results:

Any user plane packets sent between UE and gNB over the air interface after gNB sending RRCConnectionReconfiguration is integrity protected.

Expected format of evidence:

Evidence suitable for the interface e.g. Screenshot containing the operational results.

4.2.2.1.3 VOID

4.2.2.1.4 RRC integrity check failure

Requirement Name: RRC integrity check failure

Requirement Reference: TS 33.501 [2], clause 6.5.1

Requirement Description: The RRC integrity checks are performed both in the ME and the gNB. In case failed integrity check (i.e. faulty or missing MAC-I) is detected after the start of integrity protection, the concerned message is discarded. This can happen on the gNB side or on the ME side, as specified in TS 33.501 [2], clause 6.5.1.

Threat References: TR 33.926 [5], clause D.2.2.2, Control plane data integrity protection

Test Case:

Test Name: TC-CP-DATA-RRC-INT-CHECK_gNB

Purpose:

Verify that RRC integrity check failure is handled correctly by the gNB.

Pre-Conditions:

Test environment with a UE. The UE may be simulated. RRC integrity protection is activated at the gNB.

Execution Steps

The UE sends a RRC message to the gNB without MAC-I;

or

The UE sends a RRC message to the gNB with a wrong MAC-I.

NOTE: RRC integrity protection is provided by PDCP. In a PDCP message without MAC-I, the last 4 Bytes of the PDCP Data will be interpreted as a wrong MAC-I and therefore the integrity check will fail.

Expected Results:

The RRC message is discarded by the gNB.

Expected format of evidence:

Sample copies of the log files.

4.2.2.1.5 UP integrity check failure

Requirement Name: UP integrity check failure

Requirement Reference: TS 33.501 [2], clause 6.6.4.2

Requirement Description: If the gNB or the UE receives a PDCP PDU which fails integrity check with faulty or missing MAC-I after the start of integrity protection, the PDU is discarded as specified in TS 33.501 [2], clause 6.6.4.2.

Threat References: TR 33.926 [5], clause D.2.2.4, User plane data integrity protection

Test Case:

Test Name: TC_GNB_UP_INTEGRITY_CHECK_FAIL

Purpose:

Verify that UP integrity check failure is handled correctly by the gNB.

Pre-Conditions:

Test environment with a UE. The UE may be simulated. UP integrity protection is activated at the gNB.

Execution Steps

The UE sends a PDCP PDU to the gNB without MAC-I;

or

The UE sends a PDCP PDU to the gNB with a wrong MAC-I.

NOTE: In a PDCP PDU message without MAC-I, the last 4 Bytes of the PDCP PDU Data will be interpreted as a wrong MAC-I and therefore the integrity check will fail.

Expected Results:

The PDCP PDU is discarded by the gNB.

Expected format of evidence:

Evidence suitable for the interface e.g. Screenshot containing the operational results.

4.2.2.1.6 Cipherring of RRC-signalling

Requirement Name: Cipherring of RRC-signalling

Requirement Reference: TS 33.501 [2], clause 5.3.2

Requirement Description: The gNB supports cipherring of RRC-signalling as specified in TS 33.501 [2], clause 5.3.2.

Threat References: TR 33.926 [5], clause D.2.2.1 – Control plane data confidentiality protection.

Test Case:

Test Name: TC-CP-DATA-CIP-RRC-SIGN_gNB

Purpose:

To verify that the RRC-signalling data sent between UE and gNB over the air interface are confidentiality protected.

Pre-Condition:

- The gNB network product shall be connected in emulated/real network environments. The UE may be simulated.
- The tester shall have access to the air interface or can capture the message at the UE.

Execution Steps:

1. The tester triggers the UE to send a Registration Request to the AMF.
2. The AMF sends a KgNB and the UE security capability to the gNB.
3. The gNB selects an algorithm and sends AS security mode command message to the UE.
4. The gNB receives AS security mode command message from the UE.

Expected Results:

Control plane packets sent to the UE after the gNB sends AS security mode command message is ciphered.

Expected format of evidence:

Evidence suitable for the interface, e.g. Screenshot containing the operational results.

4.2.2.1.7 Cipherring of user data between the UE and the gNB

Requirement Name: Cipherring of user data between the UE and the gNB

Requirement Reference: TS 33.501 [2], clause 5.3.2

Requirement Description: The gNB supports cipherring of user data between the UE and the gNB. as specified in TS 33.501 [2], clause 5.3.2.

Threat References: TR 33.926 [5], clause D.2.2.3 – User plane data confidentiality protection at gNB

Test Case:

Test Name: TC-UP-DATA-CIP_gNB

Purpose:

To verify that the user data packets are confidentiality protected over the air interface.

Pre-Condition:

- The gNB network product shall be connected in emulated/real network environments. The UE may be simulated.
- The tester shall have access to the air interface or can capture the message at the UE.

Execution Steps:

1. The tester triggers the UE to send PDU session establishment Request to the SMF.
2. The SMF sends a UP security policy with UP cipherring required or preferred to the gNB.
3. The gNB sends RRCConnectionReconfiguration with cipherring protection indication "on".
4. The tester checks any user data sent by the gNB after sending RRCConnectionReconfiguration and before the UE enters into CM-IDLE state.

Expected Results:

The user plane packets sent to the UE after the gNB sends RRCConnectionReconfiguration is confidentiality protected.

Expected format of evidence:

Evidence suitable for the interface e.g. Screenshot containing the operational results.

4.2.2.1.8 Replay protection of user data between the UE and the gNB

Requirement Name: Replay protection of user data between the UE and the gNB.

Requirement Reference: TS 33.501 [2], clause 5.3.3

Requirement Description: The gNB supports integrity protection and replay protection of user data as specified in TS 33.501 [2], clause 5.3.3.

Threat References: TR 33.926 [5], clause D.2.2.4 – User plane data integrity protection.

Test Case:

Test Name: TC-UP-DATA-REPLAY_gNB

Purpose:

To verify that the user data packets are replay protected over the air interface.

Pre-Condition:

- The gNB network product shall be connected in emulated/real network environments. The UE may be simulated.
- The tester shall have access to the air interface.

- The tester shall have access to the N3 interface.
- The tester shall activate the user plane integrity protection of user data packets.

Execution Steps:

1. The tester shall capture the user plane data sent between UE and gNB using any network analyser over the air interface.
2. Tester shall filter user plane data packets sent between UE and gNB.
3. Tester shall replay the captured user plane packets or shall use any packet crafting tool to create a user plane packet similar to the captured user plane packet and replay to the gNB.
4. Tester shall check whether the replayed user plane packets were detected by the gNB by capturing the N3 interface to see if any of the replayed user plane packets have been forwarded by the gNB.
5. Tester shall verify from the result that if the replayed user plane packets are not accepted by the gNB, the UP of the air interface is replay protected.

Expected Results:

The user plane packets sent between the UE and gNB over the air interface is replay protected.

Expected format of evidence:

- Evidence suitable for the interface, e.g. Screenshot containing the operational results.
- Log files, e.g., containing corresponding log events.

4.2.2.1.9 Replay protection of RRC-signalling

Requirement Name: Replay protection of RRC-signalling.

Requirement Reference: TS 33.501 [2], clause 5.3.3

Requirement Description: The gNB supports integrity protection and replay protection of RRC-signalling as specified in TS 33.501 [2], clause 5.3.3.

Threat References: TR 33.926 [5], clause D.2.2.2 – Control plane data integrity protection.

Test Case:

Test Name: TC-UP-DATA-RRC-REPLAY_gNB

Purpose:

To verify the replay protection of RRC-signalling between UE and gNB over the air interface.

Pre-Condition:

- The gNB network product shall be connected in emulated/real network environments.
- Tester shall have knowledge of the integrity algorithm and the corresponding protection keys.
- The tester shall have access to the air interface.
- The tester shall have access to the N2 interface.
- The tester shall activate the integrity protection of RRC-signalling.

Execution Steps:

1. The tester shall capture the data sent between UE and the gNB using any network analyser over the NG RAN air interface.
2. Tester shall filter RRC signalling packets.

3. Tester shall check for the PDCP COUNT of the filtered RRC signalling packets and shall use any packet crafting tool to create RRC signalling packets similar to the captured packets or the tester shall replay the captured RRC uplink packet to the gNB to perform the replay attack over gNB.
4. Tester shall check whether the replayed RRC signalling packets were detected by the gNB or not, by capturing over NG RAN air interface to see if any corresponding response message is received from the gNB or by capturing the N2 interface to see if any of the replayed RRC signalling packets have resulted in a message sent by the gNB (e.g. a NAS messages from inside an RRC message).
5. Tester shall verify from the result that if the replayed RRC signalling packets are not accepted by the gNB, the RRC signalling on the air interface is replay protected.

Expected Results:

The RRC signalling over the air interface is replay protected.

Expected format of evidence:

- Evidence suitable for the interface, e.g. Screenshot containing the operational results.
- Log files, e.g., containing corresponding log events.

4.2.2.1.10 Ciphering of user data based on the security policy sent by the SMF

Requirement Name: Ciphering of user data based on the security policy sent by the SMF

Requirement Reference: TS 33.501 [2], clause 5.3.2

Requirement Description: The gNB activates ciphering of user data based on the security policy sent by the SMF as specified in TS 33.501 [2], clause 5.3.2.

Threat References: TR 33.926 [5], clause D.2.2.8 – Security Policy Enforcement.

Test Case:

Test Name: TC-UP-DATA-CIP-SMF

Purpose:

To verify that activation of confidentiality protection for user data is based on the security policy sent by the SMF via AMF

Pre-Condition:

- The gNB network product shall be connected in emulated/real network environments. The UE and the 5GC may be simulated.
- The tester shall have access to the air interface.
- The tester shall have knowledge of the RRC and UP ciphering algorithm and protection keys.
- RRC ciphering is already activated at the gNB.

Execution Steps:

All execution steps are to be performed two times. Once with the UP security policies' ciphering protection in step 2 set to "required" and the second time set to "not needed".

1. The tester triggers PDU session establishment procedure by sending PDU session establishment request message.
2. Tester shall trigger the SMF to send the UP security policy with ciphering protection "required" or "not needed" to the gNB.
3. The tester shall capture the RRC reconfiguration procedure between gNB to UE over air interface. And filter the RRC reconfiguration message sent by gNB to UE.

4. The tester shall decrypt the RRC Reconfiguration message and retrieve the UP ciphering protection indication present in the captured message.
5. The tester shall verify if the UP security policy received at gNB is same as the UP ciphering protection indication notified by the gNB to the UE in the RRC Reconfiguration message.
6. Tester shall capture the RRC Reconfiguration complete message sent between UE and gNB.
7. Tester shall capture the user plane data sent between UE and gNB using any network analyser.

Expected Results:

When the received UP cipher protection indication is set to "required", the captured user plane data appear to be garbled (i.e. no longer plaintext) and the user plane packets are confidentiality protected based on the UP security policy sent by the SMF.

When the received UP cipher protection indication is set to "not needed", the captured user plane data appear to be plaintext and the user plane packets are not confidentiality protected based on the UP security policy sent by the SMF.

Expected format of evidence:

Evidence suitable for the interface, e.g. Screenshot containing the operational results.

4.2.2.1.11 Integrity of user data based on the security policy sent by the SMF

Requirement Name: Integrity of user data based on the security policy sent by the SMF

Requirement Reference: TS 33.501 [2], clause 5.3.3

Requirement Description: The gNB activates integrity protection of user data based on the security policy sent by the SMF as specified in TS 33.501 [2], clause 5.3.3.

Threat References: TR 33.926 [5], clause D.2.2.8 – Security Policy Enforcement.

Test Case:

Test Name:

TC-UP-DATA-INT-SMF

Purpose: To verify that activation of integrity protection for user data packets is based on the security policy sent by the SMF.

Pre-Condition:

- The gNB network product shall be connected in emulated/real network environments. The UE and the 5GC may be simulated.
- The tester shall have access to the air interface.
- The tester shall have knowledge of the integrity algorithm and protection keys.
- RRC integrity is activated at the gNB.

Execution Steps:

All execution steps are to be performed two times. Once with the UP security policies' ciphering protection in step 2 set to "required" and the second time set to "not needed".

1. The tester triggers PDU session establishment procedure by sending PDU session establishment request message.
2. Tester triggers the SMF to send the UP security policy with integrity protection is "required" or "not needed" to the gNB.
3. The tester captures the RRC reconfiguration message sent by gNB to UE over NG RAN air interface.

4. The tester decrypts the RRC reconfiguration message and retrieve the UP integrity protection indication presenting in the decrypted message.
5. Tester checks whether UP integrity is enabled /disabled to verify if the UP security policy received at gNB is same as the UP integrity protection indication notified by the gNB to the UE in the RRC reconfiguration message.
6. Tester captures the user plane data sent between UE and gNB using any network analyser.

Expected Results:

When the received UP integrity protection is set to "required", the user plane packets are integrity protected based on the security policy sent by the SMF.

When the received UP integrity protection is set to "not needed", the user plane packets are not integrity protected based on the security policy sent by the SMF.

Expected format of evidence:

Evidence suitable for the interface, e.g. Screenshot containing the operational results.

4.2.2.1.12 AS algorithms selection

Requirement Name: AS algorithms selection

Requirement Reference: TS 33.501 [2], clause 6.7.3.0 and clause 5.11.2.

Requirement Description: The gNB selects the algorithms to use dependent on: the UE security capabilities of the UE, the configured allowed list of security capabilities of the currently gNB as specified in TS 33.501 [2], clause 5.11.2.

Each gNB is configured via network management with lists of algorithms which are allowed for usage. There is one list for integrity algorithms, and one for ciphering algorithms. These lists are ordered according to a priority decided by the operator as specified in TS 33.501 [2], clause 6.7.3.0.

Threat References: TR 33.926 [5], D.2.2.5 – AS algorithm selection and use

Test Case:

Test Name: TC-AS-alg-select_gNB

Purpose:

Verify that the gNB selects the algorithms with the highest priority in its configured list.

Pre-Conditions:

Test environment with the gNB has been pre-configured with allowed security algorithms with priority.

Execution Steps

- 1) The tester triggers the UE to send registration request message to the gNB.
- 2) The gNB receives UE context setup request message.
- 3) The gNB sends the AS SECURITY MODE COMMAND message.
- 4) The UE replies with the AS SECURITY MODE COMPLETE message.

Expected Results:

The gNB initiates the SECURITY MODE COMMAND message that includes the chosen algorithm with the highest priority according to the ordered lists and is contained in the UE NR security capabilities.

The MAC in the AS SECURITY MODE COMPLETE message is verified, and the AS protection algorithms are selected and applied correctly.

Expected format of evidence:

Sample copies of the log files.

4.2.2.1.13 Key refresh at the gNB

Requirement Name: Key refresh at the gNB

Requirement Reference: TS 33.501 [2], clause 6.9.4.1; TS 38.331 [6], clause 5.3.1.2

Requirement Description: Key refresh is possible for K_{gNB} , $K_{\text{RRC-enc}}$, $K_{\text{RRC-int}}$, $K_{\text{UP-enc}}$, and $K_{\text{UP-int}}$ (if available), and is to be initiated by the gNB/ng-eNB when a PDCP COUNTs are about to be re-used with the same Radio Bearer identity and with the same K_{gNB} , as specified in TS 33.501 [2], clause 6.9.4.1.

The network is responsible for avoiding reuse of the COUNT with the same RB identity and with the same key, e.g. due to the transfer of large volumes of data, release and establishment of new RBs, and multiple termination point changes for RLC-UM bearers and multiple termination point changes for RLC-AM bearer with SN terminated PDCP re-establishment (COUNT reset) due to SN only full configuration whilst the key stream inputs (i.e. bearer ID, security key) at MN have not been updated. In order to avoid such re-use, the network e.g. uses different RB identities for RB establishments, change the AS security key, or an RRC_CONNECTED to RRC_IDLE/RRC_INACTIVE and then to RRC_CONNECTED transition as specified in TS 38.331 [6], clause 5.3.1.2.

Threat References: TR 33.926 [5], clause D.2.2.7 Key Reuse

Test Case:

Test Name: TC_GNB_KEY_REFRESH_DRB_ID

Purpose:

Verify that the gNB performs K_{gNB} refresh when DRB-IDs are about to be reused under the following conditions:

- the successive Radio Bearer establishment uses the same RB identity while the PDCP COUNT is reset to 0, or
- the PDCP COUNT is reset to 0 but the RB identity is increased after multiple calls and wraps around.

Pre-Conditions:

- Test environment with UE, which may be simulated
- Test environment with one of the following setups:
 - AMF and SMF, may be simulated (applicability depends on implementation)
 - IMS, may be simulated.

Execution Steps

- 1) The tester triggers the gNB to send the AS Security Mode Command message to the UE.
- 2) The UE responds with the AS Security Mode Complete message.
- 3) A DRB is set up.
- 4) The tester sets up and tears down the DRB for multiple times within one active radio connection without the UE going to idle (e.g. by triggering the UE to make multiple IMS calls, or by triggering the SMF to request PDU session modification and deactivation via the AMF), until the DRB ID is reused.

NOTE: Depending on the implementation, PDU session modification/deactivation can release an active radio connection. In that case, the test can require IMS session and data session to setup/teardown that triggers DRB release/re-establishment.

Expected Results:

Before DRB ID reuse, the gNB takes a new K_{gNB} into use by e.g. triggering an intra-cell handover or triggering a transition from RRC_CONNECTED to RRC_IDLE or RRC_INACTIVE and then back to RRC_CONNECTED.

NOTE: Random Access Procedure defined in clause 9.2.6 of TS 38.300[8] runs in the above procedures.

Expected format of evidence:

Part of log that shows all the DRB identities and the corresponding procedure. This part can be presented, for example, as a screenshot.

4.2.2.1.14 Bidding down prevention in Xn-handovers

Requirement Name: Bidding Down Prevention

Requirement Reference: TS 33.501 [2], clause 6.7.3.1

Requirement Description: In the Path-Switch message, the target gNB/ng-eNB sends the UE's 5G security capabilities received from the source gNB/ng-eNB to the AMF, as specified in TS 33.501 [2], clause 6.7.3.1.

Threat References: TR 33.926 [5], clause D.2.2.6 Bidding Down on Xn-Handover

Test Case:

Test Name: TC-Xn-handover_bid_down_gNB

Purpose:

Verify that bidding down is prevented in Xn-handovers.

Pre-Conditions:

Test environment with source gNB and target gNB, and the source gNB may be simulated.

Execution Steps:

The tester triggers the target gNB to send the path-switch message to the AMF.

Expected Results:

The UE NR security capabilities are in the path-switch message.

Expected format of evidence:

Snapshots containing the result.

4.2.2.1.15 AS protection algorithm selection in gNB change

Requirement Name: AS protection algorithm selection in gNB change.

Requirement Reference: TS 33.501 [2], clauses 6.7.3.1 and 6.7.3.2

Requirement Description: The target gNB/ng-eNB selects the algorithm with highest priority from the received 5G security capabilities of the UE according to the prioritized locally configured list of algorithms (this applies for both integrity and ciphering algorithms). The chosen algorithms are indicated to the UE in the Handover Command message if the target gNB/ng-eNB selects different algorithms compared to the source gNB/ng-eNB as specified in TS 33.501 [2], clause 6.7.3.1, and clause 6.7.3.2.

Threat References: TR 33.926 [5], D.2.2.5 – AS algorithm selection and use

Test Case:

Test Name: Alg_select_change_gNB

Purpose:

Verify that AS protection algorithm is selected correctly.

Pre-Conditions:

Test environment with source gNB, target gNB and AMF. Source gNB and AMF may be simulated.

Execution Steps:

Test Case 1:

1. The tester triggers the source gNB to transfer the ciphering and integrity algorithms used in the source cell to the target gNB in the handover request message.
2. Target gNB verifies the algorithms and selects AS algorithms which have the highest priority according to the ordered lists. Target gNB includes the algorithm in the handover command.

Test Case 2:

1. The tester triggers the AMF to send the UE NR security capability to the Target gNB.
2. The target gNB selects the AS algorithms which have the highest priority according to the ordered lists in the HANDOVER COMMAND.

The above test cases assume that the algorithms selected by the target gNB are different from the ones received from the source gNB.

Expected Results:

For both test cases:

The selected AS ciphering and integrity protection algorithms in the handover complete message have the highest priority according to the ordered list.

The MAC in the handover complete message is valid and is based on the correctly selected AS ciphering and integrity protection algorithms.

Expected format of evidence:

Snapshots containing the result.

4.2.2.1.16 Control plane data confidentiality protection over N2/Xn interface

Requirement Name: Control plane data confidentiality protection over N2/Xn interface

Requirement Reference: TS 33.501 [2], clauses 9.2 and 9.4

Requirement Description: The transport of control plane data over N2 is integrity, confidentiality and replay-protected. The transport of control plane data and user data over Xn is integrity, confidentiality and replay-protected, as specified in TS 33.501 [2], clauses 9.2 and 9.4.

Threat References: TR 33.926 [5], clause D.2.2.1 – Control plane data confidentiality protection.

Test Case: the test case in clause 4.2.3.2.4 of TS 33.117 [3]

4.2.2.1.17 Control plane data integrity protection over N2/Xn interface

Requirement Name: Control plane data integrity protection over N2/Xn interface

Requirement Reference: TS 33.501[2], clauses 9.2 and 9.4

Requirement Description: The transport of control plane data over N2 is integrity, confidentiality and replay-protected. The transport of control plane data and user data over Xn is integrity, confidentiality and replay-protected, as specified in TS 33.501 [2], clauses 9.2 and 9.4.

Threat References: TR 33.926 [5], clause D.2.2.2 – Control plane data integrity protection.

Test Case: the test case in clause 4.2.3.2.4 of TS 33.117 [3].

4.2.2.1.18 Key update at the gNB on dual connectivity

Requirement Name: Key update at the gNB on dual connectivity

Requirement Reference: TS 33.501 [2], clause 6.10.2.1; clause 6.10.3.1.

Requirement Description: When executing the procedure for adding subsequent radio bearer(s) to the same SN, the MN is expected to, for each new radio bearer, assign a radio bearer identity that has not previously been used since the last K_{SN} change. If the MN cannot allocate an unused radio bearer identity for a new radio bearer in the SN, due to radio bearer identity space exhaustion, the MN is expected to increment the SN Counter and compute a fresh K_{SN} , and then is expected to perform a SN Modification procedure to update the K_{SN} as specified in TS 33.501 [2], clause 6.10.2.1.

The MN is expected to refresh the root key of the 5G AS security context associated with the SN Counter before the SN Counter wraps around. Refreshing the root key is done using intra cell handover as described in subclause 6.7.3.3 of TS 33.501 [2]. When the root key is refreshed, the SN Counter is reset to '0' as defined above. in that same clause; as specified in TS 33.501 [2], clause 6.10.3.1.

NOTE: The following testcases are only tested when the NR-NR DC, NE-DC and EN-DC scenarios are deployed.

Threat References: TR 33.926 [5], clause D.2.2.7 Key Reuse

Test Case 1:

Test Name: TC_GNB_DC_KEY_UPDATE_DRB_ID

Purpose:

Verify that the gNB under test acting as a Master Node (MN) performs K_{SN} update when DRB-IDs are about to be reused.

Pre-Conditions:

- Test environment with a gNB or ng-eNB acting as the Secondary Node (SN), which may be simulated
- Test environment with a UE, SMF and AMF, which may be simulated

Execution Steps

1. The tester triggers the gNB under test to establish RRC connection and AS security context with the UE.
2. The gNB under test establishes security context between the UE and the SN for the given AS security context shared between the gNB under test and the UE; and generates a K_{SN} sent to the SN.
3. A SCG bearer is set up between the UE and the SN.
4. The tester triggers the gNB under test to execute the SN Modification procedure to provide additional available DRB IDs to be used for SN terminated bearers (e.g. by triggering the UE to make multiple IMS calls, or by triggering the SMF to request PDU session modification and deactivation via the AMF), until the DRB IDs are reused.

Expected Results:

- Before DRB ID reuse, the gNB under test generates a new K_{SN} and sends it via the SN Modification Request message to the SN.

Expected format of evidence:

Evidence suitable for the interface, e.g. text representation of the captured SN Modification Request message.

Test Case 2:

Test Name: TC_GNB_DC_KEY_UPDATE_SN_COUNTER

Purpose:

Verify that the gNB under test acting as a Master Node (MN) performs K_{NG-RAN} (AS root key) update when SN COUNTER is about to wrap around.

Pre-Conditions:

- Test environment with a gNB or ng-eNB acting as the Secondary Node (SN), which may be simulated
- Test environment with a UE, SMF and AMF, which may be simulated.

Execution Steps

1. The tester triggers the gNB under test to establish RRC connection and AS security context with the UE.
2. The gNB under test establishes security context between the UE and the SN for the given AS security context shared between the gNB under test and the UE; and generates a K_{SN} sent to the SN and increases the value of SN Counter.
3. A SCG bearer is set up between the UE and the SN.
4. The tester triggers the gNB under test to execute the SN Modification procedure to provide updated K_{SN} to SN, until the SN Counter value wraps around.

Expected Results:

- Before SN Counter wraps around, the gNB under test takes a new K_{NG-RAN} into use by e.g. triggering an intra-cell handover or triggering a transition from RRC_CONNECTED to RRC_IDLE or RRC_INACTIVE and then back to RRC_CONNECTED.

NOTE: Random Access Procedure defined in clause 9.2.6 of TS 38.300[8] runs in the above procedures.

Expected format of evidence:

Part of log that shows the SN Counter values before and after wrapping around and the corresponding procedure. This part can be presented, for example, as a screenshot.

4.2.2.1.19 UP security activation in Inactive scenario

Requirement Name: UP security activation in Inactive scenario

Requirement Reference: TS 33.501 [2], clause 6.8.2.1.3.

Requirement Description: If the UP security activation status can be supported in the target gNB/ng-eNB, the target gNB/ng-eNB uses the UP security activations that the UE used at the last source cell. Otherwise, the target gNB/ng-eNB responds with an RRC Setup message to establish a new RRC connection with the UE as specified in TS 33.501 [2], clause 6.8.2.1.3.

Threat Reference: TR 33.926 [5], clause D.2.2.9 State transition from inactive state to connected state.

Test Case:

Test Name: TC_GNB_INACTIVE_TO_ACTIVE

Purpose:

Verify that the target gNB/ng-eNB uses the UP security activation status to activate the UP security.

Pre-Conditions:

- The gNB network product shall be connected in emulated/real network environments.
- The UE may be simulated.

Execution Steps

1. The tester shall complete a Registration Procedure and PDU Session establishment procedure to make sure the gNB configure the UP security, and get the UP security activation status.
2. The gNB sends RRC Release message with a suspend config to the UE.
3. The tester deletes the UP security activation status of the UE.
4. The tester triggers the UE to send RRC Resume message.

Expected Results:

The gNB sends RRC Setup message to the UE.

Expected format of evidence:

Screenshot containing the operational results.

4.2.2.1.20 User plane data confidentiality protection over N3/Xn interface

Requirement Name: User plane data confidentiality protection over N3/Xn interface

Requirement Reference: TS 33.501 [2], clauses 9.3 and 9.4

Requirement Description: The transport of user data over N3 is integrity, confidentiality and replay-protected.

The transport of control plane data and user data over Xn is integrity, confidentiality and replay-protected as specified in TS 33.501 [2], clauses 9.3 and 9.4.

Threat References: TR 33.926 [5], clause D.2.2.3 – User plane data confidentiality protection at gNB.

Test Case: the test case in subclause 4.2.3.2.4 of TS 33.117 [3].

4.2.2.1.21 User plane data integrity protection over N3/Xn interface

Requirement Name: User plane data integrity protection over N3/Xn interface

Requirement Reference: TS 33.501[2], clauses 9.3 and 9.4

Requirement Description: The transport of user data over N3 is integrity, confidentiality and replay-protected.

The transport of control plane data and user data over Xn is integrity, confidentiality and replay-protected as specified in TS 33.501 [2], clauses 9.3 and 9.4.

Threat References: TR 33.926 [5], clause D.2.2.4 – User plane data integrity protection

Test Case: the test case in subclause 4.2.3.2.4 of TS 33.117 [3].

4.2.2.1.22 Checking expiry certificate

Requirement Name: Expired Certificate checking at base station

Requirement Reference: TS 33.310 [10], clause 7.2

Requirement Description:

Certificate Management Protocol v2 (CMPv2) [11] may be the supported protocol to provide certificate lifecycle management capabilities for TLS entities. All TLS entities and TLS CAs may support initial enrolment by the TLS entity to the TLS CA via CMPv2, i.e. receiving a certificate from the TLS CA, and updating the key of the certificate via CMPv2 before the certificate expires.

Threat References: TBD

Test case:

Test Name: TC_EXPIR_CERT_CHK

Purpose:

Verify that the gNB can check whether its certificate issued by operator CA is about to expire and to act accordingly.

Pre-Conditions:

- If the gNB under test does not support handling certificates as defined in clause 9 of TS 33.310[10], this test does not apply.

- The gNB network product is connected in emulated/real network environments.
- A TLS CA may be emulated, if needed.
- The gNB is configured the necessary information to connect with the CA server.
- Optionally, the vendor may provide necessary information in a document, e.g. describing how to handle the case when a gNB checks the operator certificate is about to be expired.

Execution Steps

1. The tester configures the gNB with certificates that is assigned by operator CA.
2. The tester configures the UTC timer of gNB to the time when its own certificate is about to be expired.
3. The gNB initiates the CMPv2 procedure to get the new operator certificate.

Expected Results:

- The gNB raises an alarm or requests a new certificate from the CA.
- The gNB received a new operator certificate.

Expected format of evidence:

The logs and the communication flow in a .pcap file.

4.2.2.1.23 Peer certificate checking

Requirement Name: Peer certificate checking at base station

Requirement Reference: TS 33.310 [10], clause 9.5.1

Requirement Description:

- The base station may be pre-provisioned with the operator root CA certificate.
- If the base station is not pre-provisioned with the operator root CA certificate, then the base station takes the operator root certificate from the certificates received in the initialization response. The selection is based on checking which root certificate can be used to validate the received base station certificate.

NOTE1: Examples on validation factors defined in clause 6.3.1 of TS 33.310[10] can be taken into consideration, for example, whether the certificated has been revoked, expired, on the CRL distribution point is empty, etc.

Test case:

Test Name: TC_PEER_CERT_CHK

Purpose:

Verify that the gNB has the ability to check the peer certificate is valid or not.

Pre-Conditions:

- If the gNB under test does not support handling certificates as defined in clause 9 of TS 33.310[10], this test does not apply.
- The gNB is configured with or has obtained an operator root CA certificate.
- The gNB network product shall be connected in emulated/real network environments.
- A peer, e.g., AMF, SEG, gNB may be emulated.

NOTE2: According to 5GS, only AMF, SEG/UPF, gNB can connect to a gNB. The peer means the network function that provides the operator assigned certificate to the gNB for establishing the N2, N3, Xn interfaces.

- The gNB is configured the necessary information to connect with the peer.
- Optionally, the vendor may provide necessary information in a document, e.g., describing the checking factors and how to handle the case when a gNB validate the certificate is invalid.

Execution Steps:

1. The tester configures the peer with an invalid certificate e.g., by using a wrong signature or a certificate that has expired.
2. The tester triggers the gNB to connect to the peer.

Expected Results:

The gNB does not connect with the peer and may raise an alarm at the same time.

Expected format of evidence:

The logs and the communication flow in a .pcap file.

4.2.3 Technical Baseline

4.2.3.1 Introduction

The present clause provides baseline technical requirements.

4.2.3.2 Protecting data and information

4.2.3.2.1 Protecting data and information – general

There are no gNB-specific additions to clause 4.2.3.2.1 of TS 33.117 [3].

4.2.3.2.2 Protecting data and information – unauthorized viewing

There are no gNB-specific additions to clause 4.2.3.2.2 of TS 33.117 [3].

4.2.3.2.3 Protecting data and information in storage

There are no gNB-specific additions to clause 4.2.3.2.3 of TS 33.117 [3].

4.2.3.2.4 Protecting data and information in transfer

There are no gNB-specific additions to clause 4.2.3.2.4 of TS 33.117 [3].

4.2.3.2.5 Logging access to personal data

The requirement and testcase in clause 4.2.3.2.5 of TS 33.117 [3] are not applicable to the gNB network products.

4.2.3.3 Protecting availability and integrity

There are no gNB-specific additions to clause 4.2.3.3 of TS 33.117 [3].

4.2.3.4 Authentication and authorization

4.2.3.4.1 Authentication attributes

gNB-specific adaptation to clause 4.2.3.4.2.1 of TS 33.117 [3] is:

Dual-factor authentication by combining several authentication options as noted in clause 4.2.3.4.2.1 of TS 33.117 [3] for higher level of security is not applicable to the gNB.

Apart from the above exception, there are no other gNB-specific adaptations to clause 4.2.3.4 of TS 33.117 [3].

4.2.3.5 Protecting sessions

There are no gNB-specific additions to clause 4.2.3.5 of TS 33.117 [3].

4.2.3.6 Logging

There are no gNB-specific additions to clause 4.2.3.6 of TS 33.117 [3].

4.2.4 Operating systems

The gNB-specific additions to clause 4.2.4 of TS 33.117 [3] are:

For the requirement defined in clause 4.2.4.1.1.2 Handling of ICMP of TS 33.117[3]:

- Echo Reply can be sent by default.
- In case of remote base station auto deployment, Router Advertisement can be processed. Apart from the above exceptions, there are no gNB-specific additions to clause 4.2.4 of TS 33.117 [3].

4.2.5 Web servers

There are no gNB-specific additions to clause 4.2.5 of TS 33.117 [3].

4.2.6 Network devices

4.2.6.1 Protection of data and information

There are no gNB-specific additions to clause 4.2.6 of TS 33.117 [3].

4.2.6.2 Protecting availability and integrity

4.2.6.2.1 Packet filtering

There are no gNB-specific additions to clause 4.2.6.2.1 of TS 33.117 [3].

4.2.6.2.2 Interface robustness requirements

There are no gNB-specific additions to clause 4.2.6.2.2 of TS 33.117 [3].

4.2.6.2.3 GTP-C Filtering

The requirement and testcase in clause 4.2.6.2.3 of TS 33.117 [3] is not applicable to gNB network products.

4.2.6.2.4 GTP-U Filtering

There are no gNB-specific additions to clause 4.2.6.2.4 of TS 33.117 [3].

4.2.7 Void

4.3 gNodeB-specific adaptations of hardening requirements and related test cases.

4.3.1 Introduction

The present clause contains gNB-specific adaptations of hardening requirements and related test cases.

4.3.2 Technical Baseline

There are no gNB-specific additions to clause 4.3.2 of TS 33.117 [3].

4.3.3 Operating Systems

There are no gNB-specific additions to clause 4.3.3 of TS 33.117 [3].

4.3.4 Web Servers

There are no gNB-specific additions to clause 4.3.4 of TS 33.117 [3].

4.3.5 Network Devices

There are no gNB-specific additions to clause 4.3.5 of TS 33.117 [3].

4.3.6 Network Functions in service-based architecture

The requirements and test cases in clause 4.3.6 of TS 33.117 [3] are not applicable to the gNB network products.

4.4 gNodeB-specific adaptations of basic vulnerability testing requirements and related test cases

4.4.1 Introduction

There are no gNB specific additions to clause 4.4.1 of TS 33.117 [3].

4.4.2 Port Scanning

There are no gNB specific additions to clause 4.4.2 of TS 33.117 [3].

4.4.3 Vulnerability scanning

There are no gNB specific additions to clause 4.4.3 of TS 33.117 [3].

4.4.4 Robustness and fuzz testing

The test cases under clause 4.4.4 of TS 33.117 [3] are applicable to gNB.

The interfaces defined for the gNB are in clause 4.2.3 of TS 23.501 [7] and in clause 4.1 of TS 38.300 [8].

According to clause 4.4.4 of TS 33.117 [3], the transport protocols available on the interfaces providing IP-based protocols need to be robustness tested. Following TCP/IP layer model and considering all the protocols over transport layer, for gNB, the following interfaces and protocols are in the scope of the testing:

- For N2: the SCTP and NGAP protocols.
- For N3: the UDP and GTP-U protocols.
- For Xn: the SCTP and XnAP protocols for the control plane, and the UDP and GTP-U protocols for the user plane.

NOTE: There could be other interfaces and/or protocols requiring testing under clause 4.4.4 of TS 33.117 [3]

Annex A (informative): Change history

Change history							
Date	Meeting	TDoc	CR	R ev	Cat	Subject/Comment	New version
2019-06	SA#84					Upgrade to change control version	16.0.0
2019-09	SA#85	SP-190688	0001	-	F	Add abbreviation and correct references	16.1.0
2019-09	SA#85	SP-190688	0002	1	F	Editorial corrections on the threat references of some test cases	16.1.0
2019-09	SA#85	SP-190688	0003	1	F	Update requirements and test cases for gNB SCAS	16.1.0
2019-09	SA#85	SP-190688	0005	-	F	Correction to test case requirement reference	16.1.0
2019-12	SA#86	SP-191138	0006	-	F	Adding the expected evidence	16.2.0
2019-12	SA#86	SP-191138	0007	1	F	Update testcases for gNB SCAS	16.2.0
2019-12	SA#86	SP-191138	0008	-	F	Fix the reference numbers	16.2.0
2019-12	SA#86	SP-191138	0010	1	F	Corrections for clean-up and alignment	16.2.0
2020-03	SA#87E	SP-200136	0011	1	B	Complete the test cases of key refresh at the gNB	16.3.0
2020-03	SA#87E	SP-200136	0012	-	B	A new test case for key update at the gNB on dual connectivity	16.3.0
2020-07	SA#88E	SP-200358	0013	1	F	Update testcase in gNB SCAS	16.4.0
2020-07	SA#88E	SP-200358	0014	1	F	Remove mismatched threat references and test steps	16.4.0
2020-09	SA#89E	SP-200703	0015	-	F	gNB-specific adaptation to account protection by authentication attribute	16.5.0
2021-03	SA#91e	SP-210117	0019	1	F	gNB Cipher Security Policy Verification	16.6.0
2021-03	SA#91e	SP-210117	0020	1	F	gNB Integrity Security Policy Verification	16.6.0
2021-06	SA#92e	SP-210446	0021	-	F	Editorial correction in clause 4.2.2.1.5	16.7.0
2021-06	SA#92e	SP-210446	0023	1	F	Update conditions of testcases	16.7.0
2021-06	SA#92e	SP-210440	0024	-	B	CR to include R-16 feature of gNB to 33.511	17.0.0
2021-12	SA#94e	SP-211371	0026	1	F	Update testcases to clause 4.2.2.1.18 and 4.2.2.1.19	17.1.0
2022-09	SA#97e	SP-220887	0032	-	A	Corrections for gNB test cases	17.2.0
2022-12	SA#98e	SP-221148	0035	-	A	Corrections to the test cases in TS 33.511	17.3.0
2022-12	SA#98e	SP-221148	0037	-	A	Corrections to the threat references in TS 33.511	17.3.0
2023-02						Refreshing table of contents	17.3.1
2023-06	SA#100	SP-230615	0041	1	A	Correcting some references in TS 33.511	17.4.0
2023-06	SA#100	SP-230604	0042	1	F	SCAS release reference corrections	18.0.0
2023-06	SA#100	SP-230604	0044	-	B	Changes for SCAS gNB for Rel18	18.0.0
2023-09	SA#101	SP-230905	0045	2	F	Linking the gNB and split gNB specifications	18.1.0
2023-09	SA#101	SP-230904	0046	1	F	Adding the missing Xn-U interface	18.1.0
2023-09	SA#101	SP-230904	0049	1	F	Correction of cross-reference in clause 4.2.3.4.1	18.1.0
2023-12	SA#102	SP-231338	0052	1	A	To replace RRC connection reconfiguration by RRC reconfiguration	18.2.0
2024-03	SA#103	SP-240364	0055	1	F	Correct the Requirement from RRC signalling to User data	18.3.0
2024-03	SA#103	SP-240364	0056	1	F	Change serving network name to gNB	18.3.0
2024-03	SA#103	SP-240364	0059	1	F	Test case update to TS 33.511	18.3.0
2024-03	SA#103	SP-240360	0064	1	A	Change RRC SQN to PDCP COUNT	18.3.0
2024-03	SA#103	SP-240364	0065	-	F	update UP policy testing to align with split gNB SCAS	18.3.0
2025-01	SA#106	SP-241798	0013	-	B	Adding certificate test cases to TS 33.511	19.0.0
2025-03	SA#107	SP-250098	0073		F	Correction of TC UP replay protection	19.1.0
2025-03	SA#107	SP-250098	0074		F	Correction of TC RRC replay protection	19.1.0
2025-03	SA#107	SP-250098	0075	1	F	Correction of Expected Results in AS algorithm selection in Handover scenario	19.1.0
2025-03	SA#107	SP-250098	0076	1	F	Correction of TC UP integrity check failure	19.1.0
2025-03	SA#107	SP-250098	0077	1	F	Clarification of gNB SCAS wording	19.1.0
2025-07	SA#108	SP-250657	0086	1	F	Addition of test names and Clean up of 33.511	19.2.0
2025-09	SA#109	SP-251020	0093	1	F	Correcting the RRC replay test case to remove the UP packets text	19.3.0
2025-09	SA#109	SP-251020	0094	1	F	Correcting the UP replay test case to remove the response messages	19.3.0
2026-03	SA#111	SP-260161	0095	-	F	Corrections and update test cases	20.0.0